

THIAGO XAVIER DE MELO

August 20, 2026

Syracuse University
Department of Philosophy
541 Hall of Languages

+1 315 289 0624
✉ txdemelo@gmail.com
🌐 txdemelo.github.io

Education

PhD in Philosophy, Department of Philosophy, Syracuse University, “The Naturalness and Structure of Relations,” 2024. Advisor: Kris McDaniel and Mark Heller

MA in Philosophy (Logic and Metaphysics), Graduate Program in Logic and Metaphysics, Universidade Federal do Rio de Janeiro, “The Problem of Universals as a Problem of Ontological Categorization,” 2013. Advisor: Guido Imaguire

BA in Philosophy, Magna cum laude, Universidade Federal do Ceará, “Frege on *Elucidations*,” 2010. Advisor: Andre Leclerc and Dirk Greimann

Areas

Specialization: Metaphysics

Competence: Philosophy of Language, Logic, Philosophy of Science, Epistemology, Ethics

Publications

‘Position-Relative Naturalness,’ *The Journal of Philosophy*, forthcoming.

‘Naïve Positionalisms with Unlimited Symmetries,’ *Philosophical Studies*, forthcoming.

‘Negative Natural Properties, Categories, and Mistakes,’ *Synthese*, Volume 206, 2025

‘Essence and Naturalness,’ *The Philosophical Quarterly*, Volume 69, Issue 276, July 2019, Pages 534–554.

Manuscripts

A paper on naturalness, change, and dialetheism

A paper on positionalism about relations and regress

A paper on composition of relational states

Yet another paper on positionalism

A paper on laws and counterfactuals

Grants and Awards

- 2023 Outstanding TA Award, *The Graduate School, Syracuse University*
- 2022 Graduate Student Presentation Award, *Centennial Conference of the Creighton Club*
- 2022, 2019 Summer Grant, *Philosophy Department, Syracuse University*
- 2015-2019 Grant from CAPES – Coordenação de Aperfeiçoamento de Pessoal de Nível Superior
- 2011-2013 Grant from CAPES – Coordenação de Aperfeiçoamento de Pessoal de Nível Superior
- 2012 Grant from DAAD – Deutscher Akademischer Austauschdienst – Winterkurs. Intensivkurs Deutsch als Fremdsprache. Institut für Internationale Kommunikation, Berlin
- 2010 Research grant from CNPq – Conselho Nacional de Desenvolvimento Científico e Tecnológico

Selected Presentations

- 2023 ‘Reductive Positionalism’, *Metaphysical Mayhem*, Rutgers University.
- 2022 ‘Naïve Positionalism and Relative Discernibility,’ winner of the Graduate Student Presentation Award for presentation at the *Centennial Conference of the Creighton Club*, Colgate University, Hamilton, NY.
- 2022 ‘Naïve Positionalism and Relative Discernibility,’ *American Philosophical Association Conference*, Pacific Meeting, Vancouver, BC.
- 2021 ‘The Naturalness of Negative Properties: a case for category-relativism,’ *American Philosophical Association Conference*, Pacific Meeting, Virtual Meeting.
- 2019 ‘Within the Predicate: Non-symmetric Relations and Comparative Naturalness,’ *American Philosophical Association Conference*, Central Meeting, Denver, CO.

Invited

- 2020 ‘Negative Natural Properties, Categories, and Mistakes in God’s Multi-color Language’, ABD Talk, Syracuse University.
- 2020 ‘A Fundamentalidade de Propriedades Negativas,’ *Núcleo de Estudos em Lógica e Filosofia Analítica*, Universidade Federal do Amazonas.
- 2018 ‘Within the Predicate: the Naturalness of Non-symmetric Relations’, ABD Talk, Syracuse University.

Commentaries

- 2024 ‘Fundamental Laws and the Methodology of Science’ by Gabrielle Kerbel and Travis McKenna, *American Philosophical Association Conference*, Central Meeting, New Orleans, LA, 2024.
- 2023 ‘Non-Dispositional Modality’ by Yusuke Satake, *Syracuse Graduate Conference*, Syracuse, NY, 2023.
- 2023 ‘Metaphysical Infnitism and Theoretical Virtue’ by William Welchance, *American Philosophical Association Conference*, Central Meeting, Denver, CO, 2023.

- 2020 ‘Vicious Infinite Regress and Causal Power’ by Ben Cook, Syracuse University ABD Workshop Series, Syracuse, NY, Fall 2020.

Teaching Experience

- 2025 Main Instructor at Furman University:
- Introduction to Philosophy (Fall 25)
- 2018–2025 Main Instructor at Syracuse University:
- Knowledge and Reality (Fall 25, Spring 25, Fall 24, Spring 24, Fall 23, Spring 20, Spring 19, Fall 18)
 - Critical Thinking (Fall 24)
 - Introduction to Philosophy of Science (Summer 23)
 - Free Will (Summer 24, Summer 22)
 - Introduction to Moral Theory (Summer 21, Summer 20, Fall 19)
 - Logic (Summer 25, Spring 21, Summer 19, Summer 18)
- 2015–2023 Teaching Assistant at Syracuse University:
- Political Theory (Spring 23)
 - Ethics and Media Professions (Fall 22, Fall 20)
 - Introduction to Moral Theory (Spring 22, Fall 15)
 - Human Nature (Fall 21, Spring 18)
 - Knowledge and Reality (Fall 17, Spring 17)
 - Logic (Fall 16, Spring 16)
- 2014–2015 Main Instructor at Universidade Federal de Alagoas:
- Introduction to Philosophy (two classes)
 - Critical Thinking and Scientific Methods (two classes)
 - Ontology in Medieval Philosophy

Other Work & Experience

- Summer 2025 Research Assistant (Assisting Mark Heller develop a Grad Seminar on Properties)
- 2024 Translation of Amie Thomasson’s *Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy* entry ‘Categories’ into Portuguese. forthcoming at *Série Investigação Filosófica*, NEPFil.
- 2022 *Future Professoriate Program*, awarded *Certificate in University Teaching*.

Service

- 2024–present PhilPapers Editor, ‘Relations’
- 2023 Co-organizer of the SPAWN on Laws of Nature, (with Erica Shumener and Josh Hunt)
- 2020, 2023 Referee for Summer Grant Research Proposals, Philosophy Department, Syracuse University

- 2015–2024 Referee for SU’s Graduate Student Conference
- 2020 Referee for *Philosophical Studies*
- 2019–2020 Member of the SU’s Graduate Conference Internal/External Committee
- 2019–2020 Colloquia and job talks catering coordinator
- 2016–2017 Working Papers co-organizer